- Residential Treatment Centers (RTCs)
  - An institution that is primarily engaged in providing: (1) 24-hour residential evaluation, treatment, and comprehensive specialized services relating to the individual's specific mental health, and/or substance use disorder therapy needs, all under the active participation and direction of a licensed physician who is practicing within the scope of the physician's license; and (2) specialized programs for persons who need short-term services designed to achieve predicted outcomes focused on fostering improvement or stability in mental health and/or substance use disorder, recognizing the individuality, strengths, and needs of the persons served; and (3) care that meets evidence-based treatment guidelines or criteria as determined by the plan.
  - The services are provided for a fee from its patients and include both: (1) room and board; and (2) 24-hour-a-day registered nursing services. Additionally, the RTC keeps adequate patient records which include: (1) the individualized treatment plan; and (2) the person's progress; and (3) discharge summary; and (4) follow-up programs. Benefits are available for services performed and billed by RTCs, as described in Section 5(e), *Mental Health and Substance Use Disorder Benefits*.
  - RTCs must be: (1) operated pursuant to law; and (2) accredited by a nationally recognized organization, and licensed by the state, district or territory to provide residential treatment for mental health conditions and/or substance use disorder; or (3) credentialed by a network partner.
  - The term RTC does not include a convalescent home, extended care facility, skilled nursing facility, group home, halfway house, sober home, transitional living center or treatment, or any institution or part thereof which: (1) is used principally as a convalescent facility, nursing facility, or long-term care; (2) furnishes primarily domiciliary or custodial care, including training in the routines of daily living; or (3) is operating or licensed as a school.

- **Transitional care**

Specialty care: You may continue seeing your specialist and receiving any PPO benefits for up to 90 days if you are undergoing treatment for a chronic or disabling condition and you lose access to your specialist because:

- we drop out of the Program and you enroll in another Plan (or become covered as a family member under another Plan), or
- we terminate our contract with your PPO specialist for reasons other than for cause.

Contact us at 800-821-6136 or, if we drop out of the Program, contact your new plan.

If you are in the second or third trimester of pregnancy and you lose access to your in-network specialist based on the above circumstances, you can continue to see your specialist and your in-network benefits will continue until the end of your postpartum care, even if it is beyond the 90 days.

Note: If you lose access to your specialist because you changed your carrier or plan option enrollment, contact your new plan.

Sex-Trait Modification: If you are mid-treatment under this Plan, within a surgical or chemical regimen for Sex-Trait Modification for diagnosed gender dysphoria, for services for which you received coverage under the 2025 Plan brochure, you may seek an exception to continue care for that treatment. Ongoing sex-trait modification hormone treatment is not a covered benefit under this plan as of 1/1/2026. Our exception process is as follows: To initiate the exception process, contact Customer Care at 800-821-6136, Monday-Friday between 8 a.m. - 8 p.m. E.T. If you disagree with our decision on your exception, please see Section 8 of this brochure for the disputed claims process.

Individuals under age 19 are not eligible for exceptions related to services for ongoing surgical or hormonal treatment for diagnosed gender dysphoria.